Yixiao HUANG

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D. in Computer Science — Sept, 2024 - Present

M.S. in Computer Science — Aug, 2026

City University of Hong Kong

B.E. in Information Engineering — Sept, 2019 – Jun, 2023

SELECTED WORKS

* denotes equal contribution.

6. Yiyou Sun, Xinyang Han, Weichen Zhang, Yuanbo Pang, Tianyu Wang, Yuhan Cao, Yixiao Huang, et al. **"Agents' Last Exam"**. The Fortieth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems Evaluations and Datasets Track (NeurIPS E&D), 2026. *Core Contributor.* [pdf] [website] [1,000+ GitHub stars]

5. Yixiao Huang, Hanlin Zhu, Zixuan Wang, Jiantao Jiao, Stuart Russell, Somayeh Sojoudi, and Song Mei. **"Transformers Provably Learn to Internalize Chain-of-Thought"**. Preprint, 2026. [pdf]

4. Xutao Ma*, Yixiao Huang*, Hanlin Zhu, and Somayeh Sojoudi. **"Breaking the reversal curse in autoregressive language models via identity bridge"**. The 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2026 **(Spotlight)**. [pdf]

3. Yixiao Huang*, Hanlin Zhu*, Tianyu Guo*, Jiantao Jiao, Somayeh Sojoudi, Michael I. Jordan, Stuart Russell, Song Mei, **"Generalization or Hallucination? Understanding Out-of-Context Reasoning in Transformers"**. The Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2025. [pdf]

2. Ziheng Cheng*, Yixiao Huang*, Hui Xu, Somayeh Sojoudi, Xuandong Zhao, Dawn Song, and Song Mei, **"OVERT: A Benchmark for Over-Refusal Evaluation on Text-to-Image Model"**. The Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems Datasets and Benchmarks Track (NeurIPS D&B), 2025. [pdf]

1. Yingcong Li*, Yixiao Huang*, Muhammed Emrullah Ildiz, Ankit Singh Rawat, and Samet Oymak, **"Mechanics of Next Token Prediction with Self-Attention"**. The 27th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS), 2024. [pdf]

Internships

Roblox
Research Intern, 3D Foundation Model Team — Jun, 2026 - Aug, 2026

- Developing post-training methods for vision-language model agents to generate procedural code for 3D modeling.

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Reviewer: AISTATS 2024,2025, ICLR 2025, ICML 2026, NeurIPS 2025,2026, TMLR

HONORS AND AWARDS

Optiver PhD Quant Focus Program
Earned return offer for a Summer 2027 Quantitative Research Internship — Apr, 2026

Tinker Research Grant ($5,000 compute credits) — Dec, 2025

Anthropic Fellows Program for AI safety research - Finalist — Oct, 2025

2025 NeurIPS Scholar Award — Oct, 2025

2024 ICML Travel Award Jun, 2024

TEACHING

EE127/227AT - Optimization Models in Engineering (UC Berkeley)
Graduate Student Instructor Fall, 2025

EE2331 - Data Structures and Algorithms (CityU)
Tutor Fall, 2022

MA1201 - Calculus and Basic Linear Algebra II (CityU)
Tutor Fall, 2020